

UX REPORT – KHAN ACADEMY

GROUP: LATE TO THE PARTY

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IMY 320 GROUP DESIGN B

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1. Introduction

The site evaluated for this report is Khan Academy (khanacademy.org), the same platform the group used as a reference point for Group Design A. For Group Design B the focus moves away from login/register and onto the course catalogue and course detail pages, since this deliverable is built around Fitts's Law and the client's request for a searchable, sortable list-style catalogue rather than a grid of cells. Khan Academy was kept as the reference site to stay consistent with the group's earlier work, and because it already has to solve the same underlying problem our client cares about: presenting a large number of items that a user has to scan, select and act on quickly and accurately.

Before designing our own catalogue and course page, we needed to understand how an established platform handles that task. This evaluation ties directly into the Group Design B brief: before building a list-based catalogue that supports fast, accurate selection, we first look at how well Khan Academy's existing clickable targets, course tiles, filters and detail-page actions, support the kind of quick, low-error interaction Fitts's Law describes.

2. Methodology

We used the same shortened User Experience Questionnaire (UEQ-S) approach as Design A, scored on a 7-point semantic differential scale (Schrepp, Hinderks and Thomaschewski, 2017). Unlike Design A, where each page was rated separately, this evaluation covers the course catalogue page and the course detail page together as a single flow, since the client's problem statement treats browsing the catalogue and opening a course as one continuous task rather than two separate ones.

Participants:

We had 3 individuals, referred to as P1, P2 and P3 for anonymity. All three reported having used online learning platforms before.

Pages evaluated:

Course Catalogue page and Course Detail page, rated together as one experience.

Procedure:

- Open the website
- Spend about 2-3 minutes exploring the course catalogue page
- Click on a course that interests them and spend 2-3 minutes on the course detail page
- Return to the form and answer the questions

Scale:

7-point semantic differential across 8 criteria:

- Obstructive - Supportive
- Complicated - Easy
- Confusing - Clear
- Boring - Exciting
- Conventional - Innovative
- Usual - Modern
- Inefficient - Efficient
- Not Interesting - Interesting

3. Participant Overview

Participant	Age
P1	26
P2	21
P3	23

4. UEQ Results

4.1 Course Catalogue & Course Detail Page (combined)

Criterion	P1	P2	P3	Average
Obstructive-Supportive	4	7	7	6.0
Complicated-Easy	4	5	7	5.3
Confusing-Clear	4	6	7	5.7
Boring-Exciting	5	2	6	4.3
Conventional-Innovative	5	4	1	3.3
Usual-Modern	5	5	3	4.3
Inefficient-Efficient	5	5	7	5.7
Not Interesting-Interesting	4	4	4	4.0

5. Findings

Highest-scoring criterion: "Obstructive-Supportive" (6.0) and "Inefficient-Efficient" (5.7) were the two strongest dimensions, with "Confusing-Clear" close behind at 5.7. All three participants could reach the catalogue, pick a course, and land on a detail page without much friction, and P3 rated Supportive, Easy, Clear and Efficient at or near the top of the scale (7, 7, 7, 7).

Lowest-scoring criterion: "Conventional-Innovative" (3.3) was the clear weakest dimension, with "Boring-Exciting" and "Usual-Modern" tied as the next lowest at 4.3. Khan

Academy's tile-based catalogue is a very familiar pattern, and participants did not find it novel or exciting, even though it worked well for them functionally.

There is also a notable spread within the low-scoring criteria. Innovative ranged from 5 down to 1, and Exciting ranged from 6 down to 2, meaning individual participants disagreed sharply on how plain the design felt, even while broadly agreeing that it was efficient and easy to use.

Considered against Fitts's Law, this pattern is informative. The high Supportive, Clear and Efficient scores suggest Khan Academy's clickable course tiles are large and consistently placed enough that participants could acquire them quickly, exactly what Fitts's Law predicts for big, well-positioned targets. This is true even though Khan Academy uses a card/tile grid rather than the list format our client wants, which tells us the strong Fitts's Law outcome is coming from target size, spacing and predictable position, not from the tile shape itself. That distinction matters directly for our list-based redesign: a list can achieve the same result Khan Academy did, provided each row is treated as a large, consistently sized and spaced target, not a piece of styled text.

The low Innovative and Modern scores are, if anything, reassuring for the brief. They show that participants tolerate, and arguably prefer, a plain and familiar layout if it is efficient and clear. Our client's request for a traditional list rather than a cell grid is not at odds with good UX outcomes; Khan Academy's data suggests users do not penalise a conventional layout provided the underlying interaction is fast and predictable.

6. Design Guidelines Derived

To build a catalogue and course detail page that support fast, low-error selection under Fitts's Law, and that satisfy the client's request for a sortable, searchable list, we derive the following guidelines from Khan Academy's data:

- Make each list row a single large click/tap target, the full row width and a comfortable height, rather than just the course title text. This is the most likely reason Khan Academy scored well on Supportive and Efficient despite using a completely different tile layout: the target itself was big and obvious.
- Add clear vertical spacing between list rows so adjacent items are not accidentally selected. This is a direct Fitts's Law spacing consideration, and it matters more in a dense list than it did in Khan Academy's already spaced-out tile grid.
- Keep the sort and search controls in a fixed, prominent position at the top of the list, ideally always visible while scrolling, since consistent target position, not just size, is part of what Fitts's Law predicts will reduce acquisition time.
- Do not over-invest in making the catalogue feel visually inventive. Khan Academy scored lowest on Innovative, and it did not hurt its Supportive or Efficient scores, so effort is better spent making sort, search and course-detail buttons large, obvious and reliably placed.
- On the course detail page, make the primary action (for example "Start course" or "Enrol") a large, high-contrast target placed near the top of the page, since that is

the single most Fitts's-Law-critical interaction once a user has already selected a course.

7. Conclusion

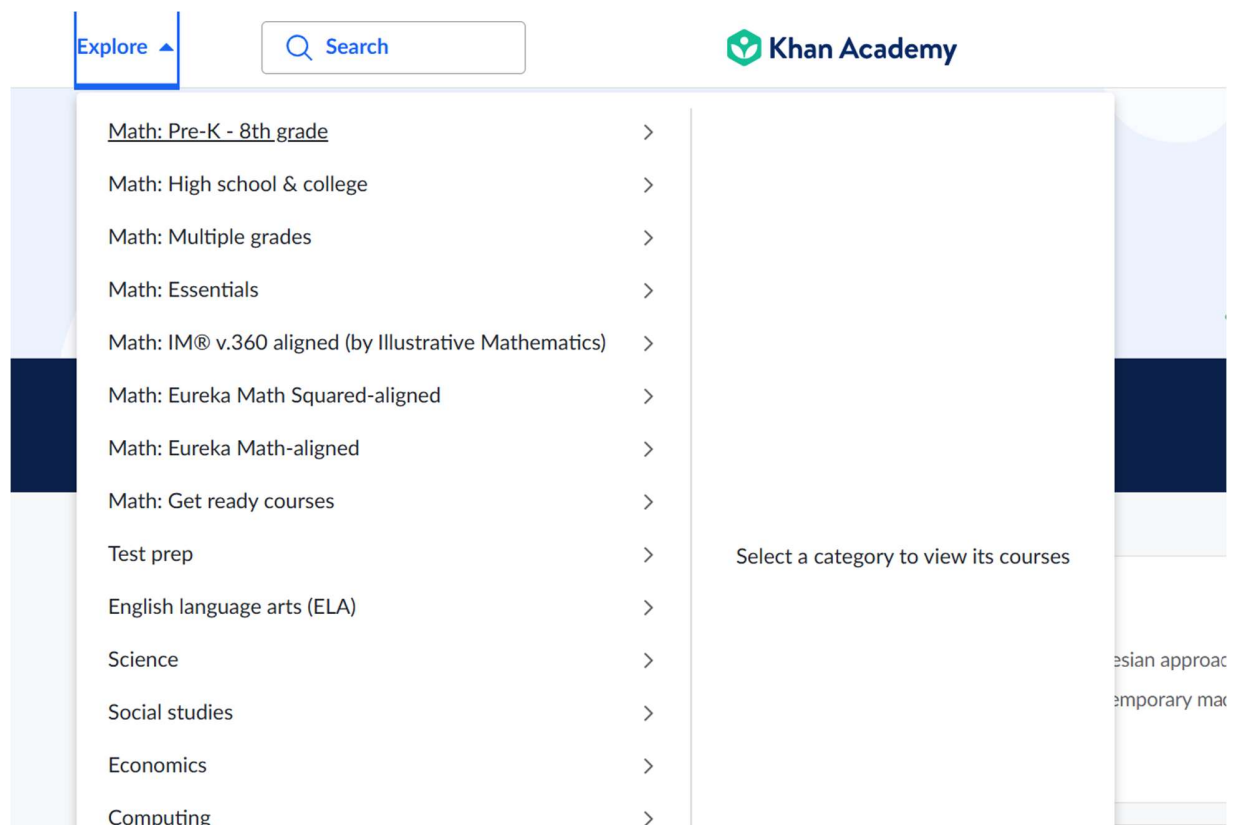
Evaluating Khan Academy's catalogue and course detail flow showed that a design can score well on supportiveness, clarity and efficiency even while using a plain, conventional layout, so long as its clickable targets are large, well-spaced and predictably placed. That is a direct demonstration of Fitts's Law in practice, and it supports the client's brief: a straightforward, sortable, searchable list does not need to look inventive to work well, it needs its targets sized, spaced and positioned so users can act on them quickly and accurately.

8. Evidence / Appendix

Raw UEQ form responses (Google Form):

<https://docs.google.com/forms/d/1KXz91nZ61iE9dcd8DLpfYVc1gJWWnZmoWsC29i43TfA/edit#responses>

Khan Academy course catalogue page:



Khan Academy course detail page:

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